HUNSAKER
& ASSOCIATES
IRVINE, INC.

PLANNING
ENGINEERING
SURVEYING
GOVERNMENT RELATIONS

IRVINE
LOS ANGELES
PALM DESERT
RIVERSIDE
SAN DIEGO

December 16, 2024

Mr. Nelson Nuezca
Engineering Manager
ELSINORE VALLEY MUNICIPAL WATER DISTRICT
31315 Chaney Street,
Lake Elsinore, CA 92530

Subject: **Response to comments CUP230002 review by EVMWD.**

Dear Nelson:

Thank you for arranging the meeting with EVWMD on 12/10/24. We appreciate the input you and Mike provided based on your concerns and the comments/questions outlined. Our responses to your comments are below and we believe these address your concerns as discussed December 10th. The following comments have references to our Preliminary Hydrology, Preliminary WQMP (includes geology/soils report), and exhibits from those documents to support the clarifications.

PRINCIPALS:
FRED GRAYLEE
BRADLEY HAY
KAMAL KARAM
DOUGLAS STALEY
JOSEPH E. WIGHTMAN

EVMWD Comments/Corrections (11/17/25 Email):

1. **Canyon Lake must be identified as a receiving water body, with designated beneficial uses including Municipal Drinking Water and full contact recreational uses.**

   Response: The proposed Crescent Garden Cemetery project (Project) being within the watershed of Canyon Lake will be added to discussions in Initial Study (IS) for CUP23002. The IS will reference in the project description, hydrology report, and Water Quality Management Plan (WQMP).

   The Project is more than 7,300 lineal feet west of the water body north of Canyon Lake. It is approximately 1.78 miles to the north of the nearest water body of Canyon Lake called Jump Lagoon, as shown in Figure 1- Vicinity to Canyon Lake.

FOUNDING PARTNERS:
RICHARD HUNSAKER
TOM R. McGANNON
JOHN A. MICHLER
DOUGLAS G. SNYDER

2. **Setback distances to adjacent streams (WOTUS) that drain to Canyon Lake must be specified.**

   Response: Project burial site pads are beyond the 25-foot setback from the 100-year floodplain boundaries as required for flood protection. Refer to Figure 2, Floodplain Exhibit .

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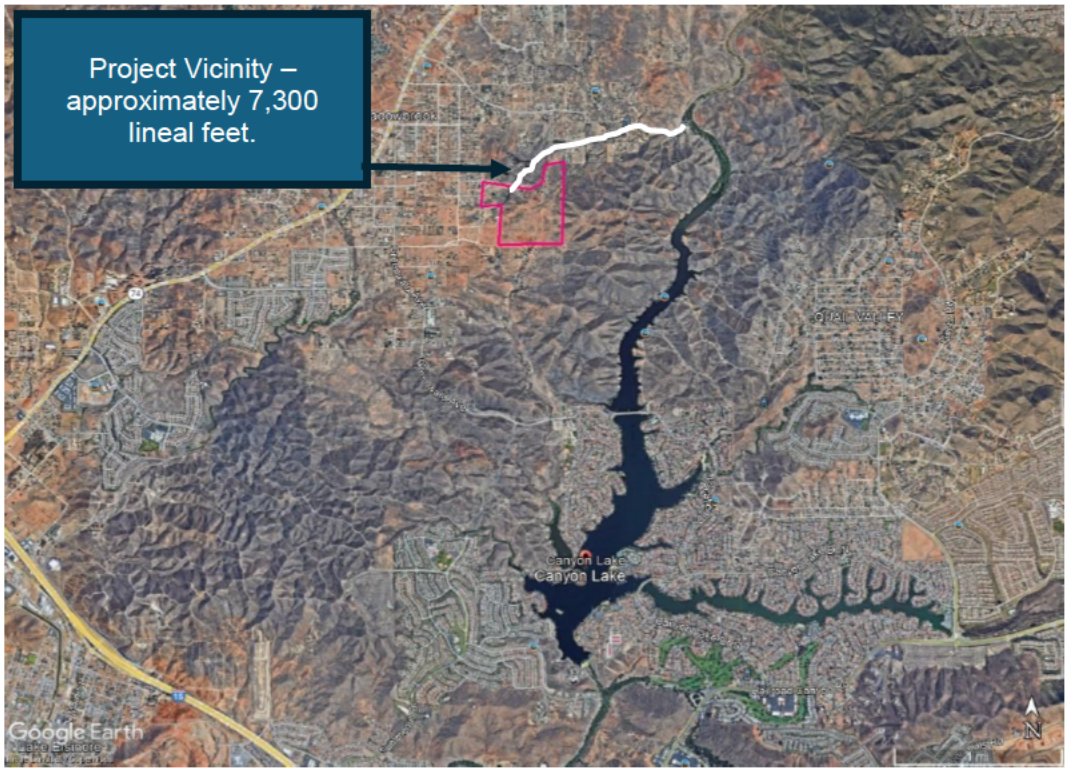


Figure 1 Vicinity to Canyon Lake

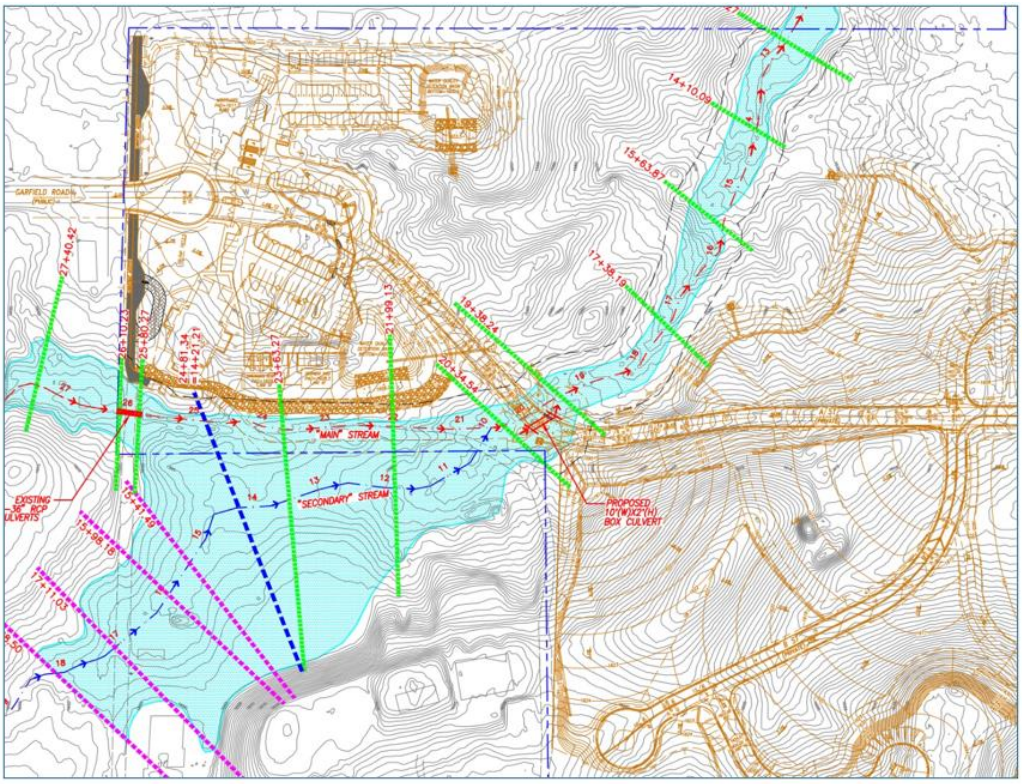


Figure 2 Flood Plain Exhibit

3. **BMPs must be specified for addressing overflow and discharges from onsite treatment ponds to adjacent WOTUS, streams that drain to Canyon Lake.**

   Response: Refer to Preliminary Water Quality Management Plan Crescent Gardens revised June 18, 2024. Please note that there are no "on site treatment ponds" in this project. There are four (4) water quality/detention basins that are BMPs for treatment of stormwater runoff from impervious areas, in conformance to County's Low Impact Development (LID) requirements for mitigation of water quality and hydromodification. Please refer to Figure 3 Typical BMP Basin cross-section.

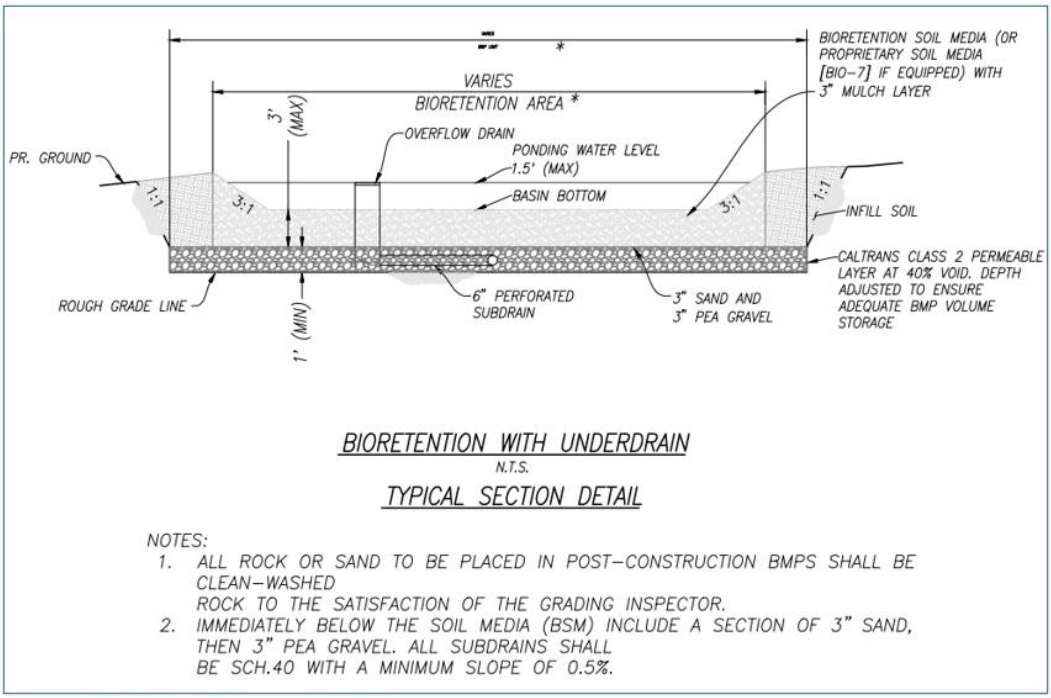


Figure 3 Typical BMP Basin

4. **BMPs must be specified to address cemetery/grave sites Leachate (due to decomposition of buried bodies) from influencing adjacent WOTUS/streams that drain to Canyon Lake.**

Response: The gravesites will be approximately five feet below finish ground surface (including regulatory 18 “inches minimum topsoil). This shallow depth ensures that the grave does not impact the local water table. The water table in this area is approximately 147 feet below ground surface. (Leighton Geology Report, 5/31/2024) Refer to Figure 4 Typical Burial Section and Figure 5 from Initial Study.

The natural burial features employed in MMCC burial include

- No embalming.
- No chemical like formaldehyde are used in ceremonial body washing and preparation.
- No casket. The deceased body is placed on ground in a cotton cloth shroud. This allows for a natural decomposition process of a human body.
- A liner is used in place of a vault; this ensures that body is placed on ground soil within the confinement of the biodegradable shroud.

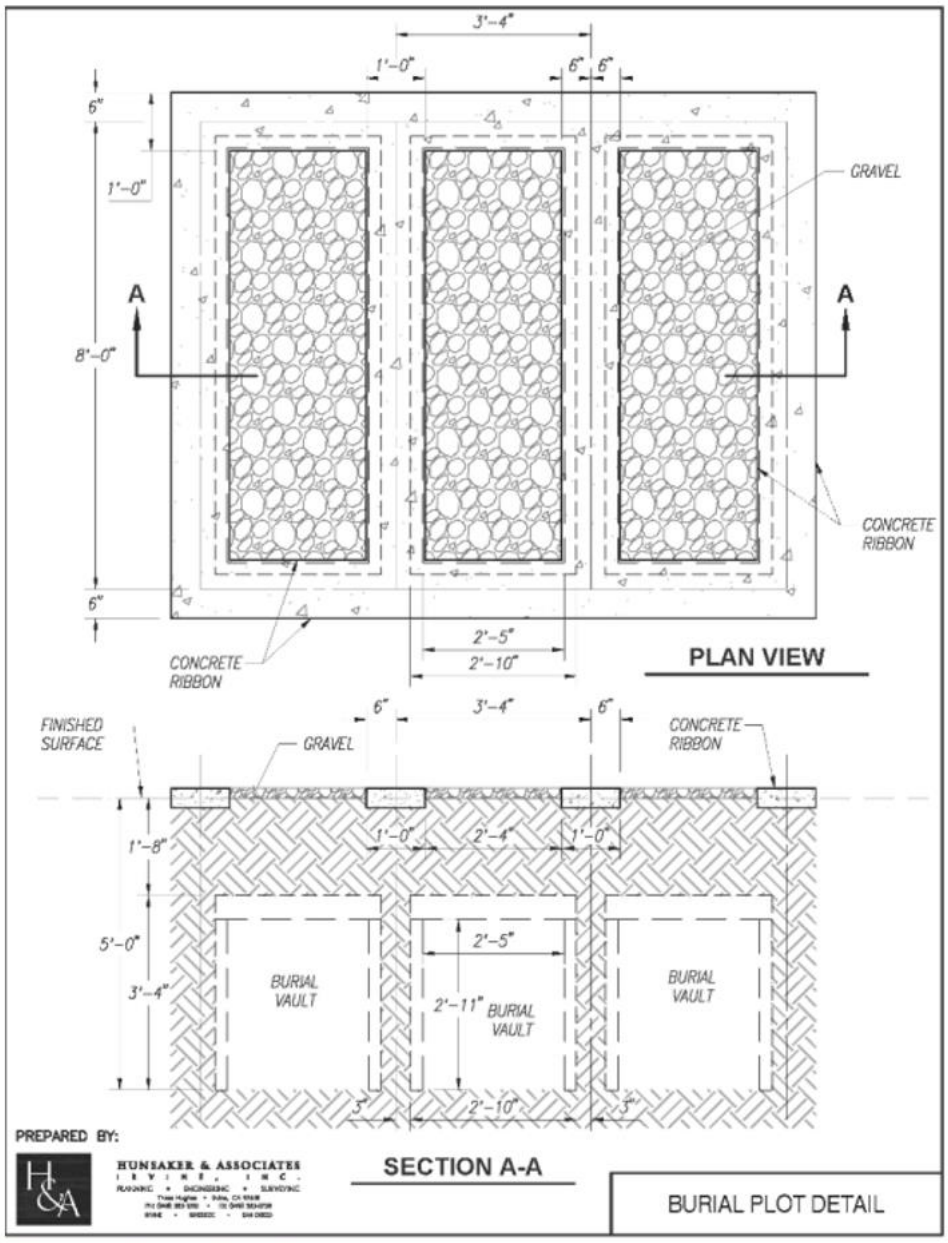
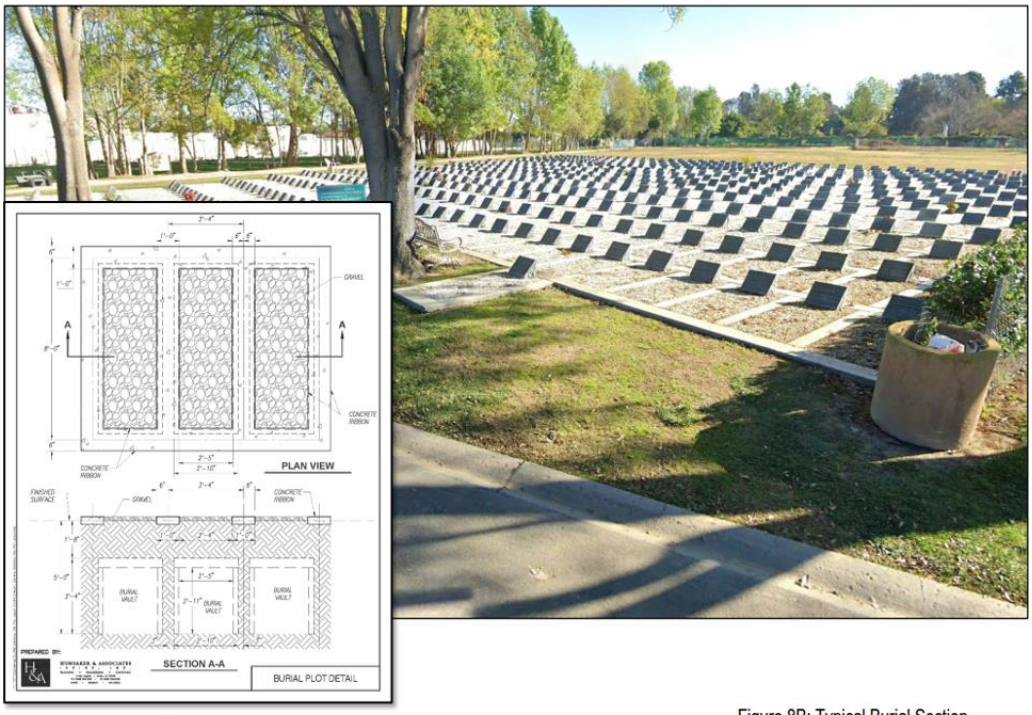


Figure 4 Burial Plot Detail

5. **Comments must be solicited from all Agencies that have Water Quality Regulatory Oversite for Canyon Lake, including SWRCB-DDW-Riverside District, Santa Ana RWQCB, City of Canyon Lake, LESJWA, and SAWPA.**

Response: As discussed 12-10-2024, an IS will be circulated for agencies to comment during notice of preparation. During this time the above agencies will be contacted via circulation of the IS from Riverside County staff to collect comments. Preliminary meetings with select agencies will occur prior to circulation of the Initial Study.



Not to Scale

Figure 8B: Typical Burial Section
Source: *Applicant Submittal*

Figure 5 Typical Burial Site

Should you have any questions, please do not hesitate to contact me at (949) 768-2507 or rglessner@hunsaker.com.

Sincerely,

HUNSAKER & ASSOCIATES IRVINE, INC.

Robert K. Glessner
Sr. Planner

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